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Troubleshooting: Time tracking hours are not syncing to payroll

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ADMINISTRATORS



TIME & ATTENDANCE

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Overview

If you notice that Rippling time tracking hours are not syncing with payroll, it may be due to the reasons listed in this guide. Review the reasons and steps to troubleshoot this issue.

Possible reasons

Hours tracked in Rippling may not sync to Payroll in the following situations:

- The hours are not approved.
- The hours have not been logged under an active pay schedule.
- The pay run was approved before the hours were logged.
- Your company account has a third-party time and attendance integration installed.
- The employee underwent a transition (e.g., change in employment type, exemption status, or work location) during an active pay period.
- Manual edits were made to the pay run.

Troubleshooting steps

Reason 1: Check if the hours are approved

Hours logged in Rippling must be approved in order for them to sync with payroll.

To check the approval status of hours, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Timecards**.
3. Select the employee's name to open the timecard.
4. Review the *Approval* status.

For more information on timecard approvals, see our guide to [how managers and admins review and approve hours recorded with time tracking](#).

Reason 2: Check if the hours are associated with a pay schedule

Employees hours must be logged under an active pay schedule in order for the approved hours to sync with a pay run.

To confirm hours are associated with a pay schedule, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Time**.
2. From the *Time* sidebar, select **Timecards**.
3. Select the drop-down menu in the top left corner to view the pay schedules.
4. Review the hours logged under *No pay schedule*. These hours are not associated with an active pay run and will not sync with payroll.

If you need to add an employee to a pay schedule, you can do so in the Payroll app. Once assigned to a pay schedule, all hours logged moving forward will sync with payroll. Hours logged under *No pay schedule* will need to be added to a pay run manually as these will not sync with a pay run.

For more information on adding an employee to a pay schedule, see our guide to [changing employee pay schedules](#).

Reason 3: Check the pay run status

If a pay run is already approved or paid, newly logged hours will not sync with the pay run. All hours must be approved prior to the pay run being approved or paid in order to sync with the pay run.

Note: After approving hours, wait a few minutes before approving the related pay run to allow the system time to sync. Although updates usually occur instantly, a short delay helps ensure all information is fully updated.

To check the pay run status, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Payroll**.
2. From the *Payroll* sidebar, select **Payroll Overview**.
3. Select the **Overview** tab.
4. On the *Upcoming* and *Paid* sub-tabs, review the *Status*.

Hours approved after the pay run is approved will automatically sync to an extra hours pay run. For more information, see our guide to [extra hour pay runs](#).

Reason 4: Check if a third-party time tracking systems are active

If a third-party time tracking system is integrated with your Rippling account, the hours from the third-party system will be prioritized. Hours cannot sync from both the third-party application and Rippling.

To disable the third-party sync and sync the hours from Rippling for an individual pay run, follow these steps:

1. From the main sidebar, select **Payroll**.
2. From the *Payroll* sidebar, select **Payroll Overview**.
3. Select the **Overview** tab > **Upcoming** sub-tab.
4. Click **Run payroll**.
5. Select **Pay run settings** in the top right corner.
6. In the *Additional Settings*, disable **Sync third-party time sheet apps**.

Sync third-party time sheet apps

Third-party T&A apps will continue syncing with Payroll

Off 

To disable the third-party sync for all future pay runs, you will need to uninstall/remove the third party time tracking integration from Rippling.

For more information on removing the third-party applications, see our guide to [uninstalling or removing apps](#).

Reason 5: Check if the employee was transitioned within the pay period

If an employee undergoes a transition (e.g., change in employment type, exemption status, or work location) during an active pay period, the system ensures that the hours worked before and after the transition are processed correctly.

How it works:

- Hours *before* the transition date will be processed in a separate transition run.
- Hours *after* the transition date will be included in the regular pay run.

For example:

Let's say Employee A's employment type changes with an effective date of September 10th—within the regular pay period of September 1st to 15th.

- The hours worked from September 10th to 15th will be paid in the regular pay run.
- The hours worked from September 1st to 10th will be paid through a system-generated transition run.

To confirm an employee's transition, follow these steps:

1. Search for the employee using the search bar on your Ripping Dashboard.
2. Click on the **View History** button located at the top-right of the employee's profile.
3. Look for any of the following types of changes and verify the effective date of the transition.
 - Changes in employment type
 - Changes in exemption status
 - Changes to work location

Once the transition is successfully processed, a system-generated transition run will appear in *Draft* status under the **Upcoming** sub-tab within the Payroll application. If the transition run is not listed, check the **Archived** sub-tab, as it may have been archived by a payroll administrator.

Reason 6: Manual edits were made to the pay run

When a manual edit is made to a pay run, automated updates are blocked to preserve the manual override. This can prevent approved hours from syncing to the pay run. To fix this, you can revert the manual changes, and hours will begin syncing again. For step-by-step instructions, see [our article about making manual changes to payroll](https://help.rippling.com/article?articleId=610303216827).

Frequently asked questions

If I manually edit an employee's earning field in the Payroll app, will time tracking data continue to sync?

No. When you manually edit an earning field for an employee in the Payroll app, Rippling stops syncing time tracking data for that specific field. This ensures that your manual changes are preserved and not overwritten. Time entries with earning types that have been edited in Payroll display a blue triangle. Hovering over the triangle triggers a tooltip indicating that the earning type has been modified in Payroll.

Timecards - 11											Export CSV
Alerts	Date	Status		Shift Clock in	Clock out	Earning type has been overridden in Payroll		1.5x Overti...	Breaks Unpaid	PTO Accr... Vacation	
	Saturday December 20	Pending approval	✓ ✕ ⋮	10:44 AM PST	07:00 PM PST (+1 day)	32h 16m	8h	24h 16m	0m	23h 16m	
	Thursday December 18	Approved	✓ ✕ ⋮	05:23 AM PST	10:38 AM PST (+1 day)	29h 15m	8h	21h 15m	0m	20h 15m	
	Tuesday December 16	Approved	✓ ✕ ⋮	09:33 AM PST	07:16 PM PST (+1 day)	33h 43m	8h	25h 43m	0m	24h 43m	

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